

# Curriculum Vitae

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## Kevin B. McGowan

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## Education

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| 2006 - 2011 | Ph.D. Linguistics, University of Michigan<br><br>Dissertation: The Role of Socioindexical Expectation in Speech Perception<br>Patrice Speeter Beddor & Steven P. Abney, co-chairs<br>Julie Boland, Benjamin Munson, & Robin Queen, committee members |
| 2007        | Linguistic Institute, Stanford University                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 1996        | B.A. Linguistics, University of Michigan                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Employment

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| 2021 -      | Associate Professor, Department of Linguistics, University of Kentucky                                              |
| 2015 – 2021 | Assistant Professor, Department of Linguistics, University of Kentucky                                              |
| 2013 – 2015 | Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Linguistics, Stanford University<br>Meghan Sumner, PI                           |
| 2011 - 2013 | Lecturer, Department of Linguistics, Rice University                                                                |
| 1997 - 2007 | Webmaster, Web Production & Database Services Team Lead, Information<br>Technology Division, University of Michigan |

## Professional Experience

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| 2019 | Invited Faculty, “Speech Perception”, Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute, University of California, Davis |
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| 2017        | Invited Faculty, “Doing phonetics research” and “Eye tracking for linguistics research” Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute, University of Kentucky |
| 2013        | Invited Faculty, “Introduction to Praat” Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute, University of Michigan                                                |
| 2007 - 2010 | Journal Assistant & Student Board Member, Language Learning Journal, Blackwell Publishing                                                                      |
| 2009 - 2010 | Research Assistant, Professor Pam Beddor, Michigan Phonetics & Phonology Laboratory                                                                            |
| 2007 - 2008 | Research Assistant, Professors Pam Beddor & A. Coetzee, Michigan Phonetics & Phonology Laboratory                                                              |
| 1997 - 2007 | Programmer &, System administrator, Manager of Web and Database production services, University of Michigan                                                    |
| 1993 - 1994 | Undergraduate Research Assistant, Professor Richard W. Bailey, Department of English, University of Michigan                                                   |

## **Publications**

McGowan, K. B., & Takvoryan, S. (submitted). The Perception of Linguistic Features. In M. Baranowski, P. De Dekker, & J. Nycz (Eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Research Methods in Sociophonetics*. Oxford University Press.

Takvoryan, S., & McGowan, K. B. (in press). The dynamic, social specification of coarticulated vowels. In R. V. Roeder & G. Alfaraz (Eds.), *Accent, attitudes, and sound change*. Benjamins.

McGowan, K. B. (2026). Toward an ecologically valid theory of speech perception. In L. Hall-Lew & J. Nycz (Eds.), *Sociophonetics: Implications for Phonetics and Phonology*. Oxford University Press.

Namboodiripad, S., Kutlu, E., Babel, A., Babel, M., Baese-Berk, M., Bassuk, P. B., Block, A., Pérez, R. C., Carlson, M. T., Carraturo, S., Cheng, A., Cheng, L. S. P., Combiths, P., Foushee, R., Frederiksen, A. T., Grammon, D., Hayes-Harb, R., Higby, E., Kendro, K., ... Wright, K. E. (2026). Finding our ROLE: How and why to reframe essentialist approaches to language. *Cognition*, 271, 106444. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2026.106444>

Babel, A. M., Campbell-Kibler, K., & McGowan, K. B. (2025). Introduction to the thematic issue. *Journal of Sociolinguistics*, 29(1), 44–58.

- Laycock, K., & McGowan, K. B. (2025). Removing the disguise: The matched guise technique, incongruity, and listener awareness. *Journal of Sociolinguistics*, 29(3), 194–209. <https://doi.org/10.1111/josl.12700>
- Barrett, R., Cramer, J., & McGowan, K. B. (2022). *English with an accent: Language, ideology, and discrimination in the united states*.
- Babel, A., McGowan, K., & Enríquez Duque, P. (2021). Niveles de percepción de las vocales en contacto: El caso de una variedad de español andino en Bolivia. *Traspasando Lo Lingü: Factores Esenciales En El Contacto de Lenguas*-(*Lengua y Sociedad En El Mundo Hispánico*; 48), 119–136.
- Medeiros, D. J., Mains, P., & McGowan, K. B. (2021). Ceiling effects on weight in heavy NP shift. *Linguistic Inquiry*, 52(2), 426–440.
- Baese-Berk, M. M., McLaughlin, D. J., & McGowan, K. B. (2020). Perception of non-native speech. *Language and Linguistics Compass*, 14(7), e12375.
- McGowan, K. B., & Babel, A. M. (2020). Perceiving isn't believing: Divergence in levels of sociolinguistic awareness. *Language in Society*, 49(2), 231–256.
- McGowan, K. B., Johnson, M. T., Combs, A., & Soleymannpour, M. (2019). Acoustic, non-invasive measurement of velopharyngeal aperture using a high frequency tone. *Proceedings of the 19th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences*, 755–759.
- Beddor, P. S., Coetzee, A. W., Styler, W., McGowan, K. B., & Boland, J. E. (2018). The time course of individuals' perception of coarticulatory information is linked to their production: Implications for sound change. *Language*, 94(4), 931–968.
- McGowan, K. B. (2016). Sounding Chinese and listening Chinese: Awareness and knowledge in the laboratory. *Awareness and Control in Sociolinguistic Research*, 25–61.
- McGowan, K. B. (2015). Social expectation improves speech perception in noise. *Language and Speech*, 58(4), 502–521.
- Sumner, M., Kim, S. K., King, E., & McGowan, K. B. (2014). The socially weighted encoding of spoken words: A dual-route approach to speech perception. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 4, 1015.
- Beddor, P. S., McGowan, K. B., Boland, J. E., Coetzee, A. W., & Brasher, A. (2013). The time course of perception of coarticulation. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 133(4), 2350–2366.
- McGowan, K. B. (2011). *The role of socioindexical expectation in speech perception* [PhD thesis]. University of Michigan.
- McGowan, K. B. (2009). Aerodynamic modeling for concatenative speech synthesis. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 126(4\_Supplement), 2222–2222.

## Grants

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|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (submitted) | Dialects of Care: Human-Centered AI Design in Rural Health Contexts<br>Mellon Concepts in Higher Learning with Jennifer Cramer, Dmitry Strakovsky, Chad Eby, and Caleb Williams submitted to |
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| 2019 - 2020 | Wildcate Voices software development UK Vice President for Research, Research and Creative Activities Grant – \$3,360 with Jennifer Cramer                                                                                                                |
| 2018 - 2019 | Method and device for acoustic, non-invasive measurement of velopharyngeal aperture using a high frequency tone Igniting Research Collaborations grant, University of Kentucky OVPR, - \$27,726 with Michael Johnson, Electrical and Computer Engineering |
| 2016        | Confucius Institute Faculty China Curriculum Development Grant - \$1,000                                                                                                                                                                                  |

### **Advising & Supervision**

- Stella Takvoryan (2025) Listening to cursive: The roles of regional identity and folk beliefs in perceptual cue-weighting, MA thesis chair
- Kaitlin Young (2025) Cognate Facilitation and Processing in English-Speaking Learners of German, MA thesis co-chair with Brenna Byrd
- Emily Ramirez (2024) Modeling the Role of Social Information in Speech Perception, UC Berkeley PhD thesis, co-chair with Keith Johnson
- Nour Kayali (2023) This Make Sense?” The Effect of Congruent Guise in Regional Accent on Grammatical Acceptability Judgments, MA thesis chair
- Jarred Brewster (2021) Language Contact and Covert Prominence in the Šherēt-Jibbāli Language of Oman, MA thesis chair
- Monica Chulde Guayasamin (2021) Face Masks and Speech Perception: Emotions and Intelligibility Perceived by Monolingual and Bilingual Speakers, MA thesis chair
- Kyler Laycock (2021) The Influence of Socioindexical Information on the Speech Perception-Production Link Evidence from a Shadowing Task, MA thesis chair
- Ollie Combs (2020) Relevant Angry Affect Slows Response Time To Commands, MA thesis chair
- Robert Bell (2019) Limón Patwa: A Perceptual Study to Measure Language Attitudes Toward Speakers of Patwa in Costa Rica, MA thesis co-chair
- Andy M Gibson (2019) Sociophonetics of popular music: insights from corpus analysis and speech perception experiments, External Examiner (not advisor)
- Mikhayla Sheeley (2019) Linguistic Relativity and the L2 Learner: An Investigation of the Effects of L2 Grammatical Gender on L1 Conceptual Gender, Undergraduate honors thesis chair
- Jaycee Taylor (2019) Lexington STEAM Academy High School Internship, Supervisor
- Philip Barnett (2018) A Markedly Different Approach: Investigating PIE Stops Using Modern Empirical Methods, MA thesis co-chair with Andrew Byrd

- June Nielsen (2018) Lexington STEAM Academy High School Internship, Supervisor
- Aidah Aljuran (2017) “Listening with an Attitude” The Role of Attitude on Native and Non-Native Intergroup Communication, MA thesis chair
- Kelly E. Wright (2017) The Reflection and Reification of Racialized Language in Popular Media, MA thesis chair
- Kaitlyn Lee (2016) The Perception of Creaky Voice Does Speaker Gender Affect our Judgments?, MA thesis chair
- Jo Mackby (2016) Cries from The Jungle: The Dialogic Linguistic Landscape of the Migrant and Refugee Camps in Calais, France, MA thesis co-chair with Mark Lauersdorf
- Ksenia Gnevshcheva (2015) Variation in passing for a native speaker: accentedness in second language speakers of English in production and perception, External Examiner (not advisor)
- John Galindo (2014) A psychoacoustic study of the influence of L1 lexical tone and pitch perception, Rice University, Qualifying Paper, chair
- Penelope Howe (2014) Investigation of cues to fricative voicing in dialects of Malagasy, Rice University, Qualifying Paper, chair
- Hussein Hizazi (2013) Formant Analysis of Jordanian Arabic Vowels: Emphasis Effect on F2 in Jordanian Arabic, Rice University, Qualifying Paper, chair
- Ling Ma (2013) Native Mandarin perception of English word boundary consonant overlap., Rice University, Qualifying Paper, chair
- Mariama Mallah (2013) Directed undergraduate research, Stanford University
- Obi Nwabueze (2013) The use of eye-tracking in speech perception research, Undergraduate Research
- Sheri-Ann Peckham (2013) Investigation of age-related perceptual plasticity using Jamaican Creole, Undergraduate Research

## **Committees and Service**

- LSA Ad Hoc Committee on Language, Conflict, and Peacebuilding, chair (2026), member (2025)

## **Selected Software Projects**

- CoSign, Open Source Web Single SignOn ( co-founder, developer )
- ChomskyBot, Pseudo-random Sentence Generator and Gentle Mockery Engine
- ldapweb, Web-based LDAP Directory Client
- kpasswd.cgi, Web-based Kerberos password changer

## Technologies

- Eyelink II head-mounted eye tracker, EG2-PCX Electroglottograph, EVA 2 pneumotachograph, Zonare Ultrasound, Praat, Wavesurfer, OpenSesame, sox, etc.
- Python, Perl, C, Bourne shell, JavaScript, awk, tcl, SQL, PL/SQL
- RDBMS systems (Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL)
- UNIX administration & programming (Linux, OpenBSD, MacOS, Solaris, etc.)
- HTML, XML, CSS, LaTeX, Markdown, Typst

## Professional affiliations

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| 2009 - | Acoustical Society of America |
| 2006 - | Linguistic Society of America |